

SKILLS FOR PROFESSIONAL FREELANCERS

Participants Handout

Session 4

Presentation Skills



01 Session Map

Learning Outcomes

- Identify the characteristics of effective presenters.
- Plan and structure clear openings, logical bodies, and purposeful closings.
- Apply visual-aid principles that improve audience understanding.
- Use effective verbal and nonverbal delivery in face-to-face and virtual settings.
- Present a concise, client-focused technical solution and respond professionally to questions.
- Evaluate AI-assisted planning, slide messaging, and rehearsal feedback for accuracy and personal voice.

Baseline Self-Assessment

Skill	1	2	3	4	5
Audience focus					
Structure					
Visual design					
Voice and presence					
Handling questions					

Reflect & Write

What is the one presentation skill you most want to improve during this session?

02 The Effective Presenter



Characteristic	What the Audience Experiences	My Evidence
Clear	Ideas are easy to follow.	
Audience-focused	The message connects to their needs.	
Structured	Opening, body, and closing work together.	
Credible	Claims are supported and delivery feels genuine.	
Confident	Voice, posture, and pace support the message.	

One-Minute Baseline

Technical idea I will explain	
My one key message	
What I did well	
What I want to improve	

Reflect & Write

How did you feel while presenting, and what evidence supports your self-assessment?

03 Plan Around the Audience



Audience analysis is a planning decision.

Before selecting content, decide what the audience should understand, decide, or do after the presentation.

Audience Analysis Canvas

Audience background	
Audience size	
Industry or technical knowledge	
Main need or concern	
What's in it for them?	
Decision or action I want	
Questions they are likely to ask	

Reflect & Write

Which piece of audience information will most change the way you present your idea?

04 AI Lab: Client-Focused Plan

Step	Action
1. Define	Describe the client, their needs, and the desired decision or action.
2. Provide	Share verified facts, constraints, benefits, and evidence. Remove confidential data.
3. Generate	Request an opening hook, three body points, a closing action, and likely questions.
4. Review	Check accuracy, relevance, sequence, and natural voice; rewrite at least one part.

Ready-to-Use Prompt

Act as a presentation coach. I need to present [technical idea/solution] to [client/audience]. Their main need is [need], and my goal is [decision/action]. Using only the verified information below - [facts/evidence] - create: 1) an opening hook, 2) three body points focused on client value, 3) a closing recommendation, and 4) three likely audience questions. Flag missing information and do not invent facts.

My Three-Part Outline

Opening hook	
Body point 1	
Body point 2	
Body point 3	
Closing recommendation	
One AI suggestion I changed	

Reflect & Write

What still required your judgment after AI generated the outline?

05 Build an Opening That Earns Attention



Opening Move	Purpose	My Draft
Welcome + introduction	Establish who you are and acknowledge the audience.	
Question or problem	Invite the audience to think immediately.	
Statistic or evidence	Create relevance and credibility.	
Story	Lead naturally to the main topic.	
Agenda	Show the structure and keep attention focused.	

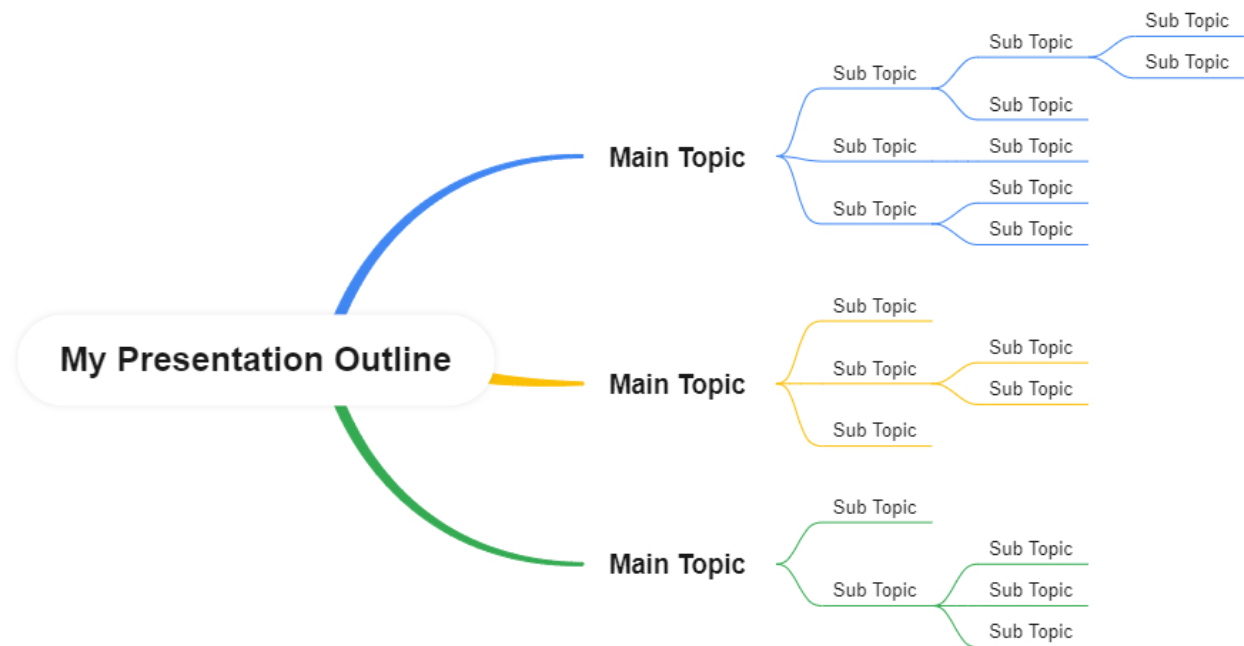
Opening Builder

My first sentence	
Why the topic matters to this audience	
My opening hook	
Three agenda points	
Transition into the body	

Reflect & Write

Read the opening aloud. Which line creates the strongest reason to keep listening?

06 Shape a Client-Focused Body



Client Solution Outline

Section	Question to Answer	My Key Point
Customer need	What problem or priority matters most?	
Features	What does the solution include?	
Benefits	What value will the client receive?	
USP	How is the solution different?	
Implementation	What timeline or steps are realistic?	
Financial offer	What commercial information is relevant?	

Keep it simple.

Use three or fewer main ideas and repeat the most important message near the beginning and the end. The 10-20-30 rule is a useful reminder: 10 or fewer slides, under 20 minutes, and at least 30-point type.

My one core message	
Three supporting points	
Evidence for the strongest point	

07 Close Clearly and Prepare for Questions



Closing Move	What It Does	My Draft
Summarize	Remind the audience of the main ideas.	
Key message	Leave one memorable takeaway.	
Call to action	State the decision or next step.	
Invite questions	Create space for clarification.	

Question Preparation

Likely Question	Evidence I Need	Short Answer	Follow-Up

A professional answer can include a boundary.

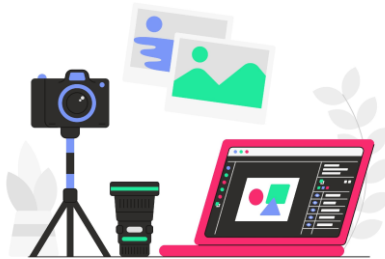
If you do not know, say what you know, state what you need to verify, and commit to a realistic follow-up.

My final key message	
My requested next step	

Reflect & Write

What should the audience remember one hour after your presentation?

08 Design Visual Aids That Support the Message



- Reinforce and clarify key points.
- Engage the audience's eyes and ears.
- Improve understanding and retention.
- Create consistency and balance.
- Strengthen confidence in the message.

Seven Visual-Aid Checks

- ☐ Keep it short and simple.
- ☐ Make it readable.
- ☐ Use the 6x6 rule as a density check.
- ☐ Use an appropriate type size and font.
- ☐ Check colors and contrast.
- ☐ Proofread every visible element.
- ☐ Use animation carefully and only when it helps.

Slide Audit

Slide	One Takeaway	Visual Purpose	What I Will Remove

Reflect & Write

Which slide in your presentation needs the biggest simplification?

09 AI Lab: Dense Content to Clear Message

Step	Action
1. Paste	Use one verified paragraph and remove confidential information.
2. Focus	Ask for the one message the audience must remember.
3. Rewrite	Generate a takeaway title and no more than three concise bullets.
4. Verify	Check every claim and confirm that the proposed visual supports the evidence.

Ready-to-Use Prompt

Act as a presentation design coach. Rewrite the verified content below for one slide. Return: 1) a takeaway title of no more than 10 words; 2) up to three bullets, no more than 10 words each; 3) the most suitable visual type and why; and 4) a 30-second speaker explanation. Preserve the meaning, flag unsupported claims, and do not invent data. Content: [paste content].

Before / After

Original dense message	
One takeaway title	
Three supporting bullets	
Recommended visual + purpose	
Claim I verified or corrected	

Reflect & Write

What meaning was at risk of being lost, and how did you protect it?

10 Deliver with Presence

Channel	What to Control	Self-Check
Eye contact	Connect with the audience or camera.	
Posture	Stand or sit with stable, open energy.	
Hand movement	Use gestures that support meaning.	
Facial expression	Match expression to message and tone.	



The Five P's of Voice

Pace	Pitch	Pronunciation	Pause	Projection
Speed	Variation	Clarity	Emphasis	Reach

Delivery Observation

Sentence or message I practised	
Strongest nonverbal behaviour	
Voice element to improve	
Feedback I received	
Change for the next attempt	

Reflect & Write

Which delivery habit most affects your credibility?

11 Deliver Strong Virtual Presentations



Virtual Presentation Readiness

- ☐ Check webcam framing and lighting before presenting.
- ☐ Test the microphone, audio source, and internet connection.
- ☐ Use a clean, appropriate background.
- ☐ Know the platform and the controls you will need.
- ☐ Look at the camera to create eye contact.
- ☐ Show genuine enthusiasm for the topic.
- ☐ Use a strong voice and vary your intonation.
- ☐ Be yourself so the delivery feels credible.

My Virtual Set-Up Check

Area	Ready?	Improvement Before Presenting
Camera + framing		
Lighting		
Microphone + internet		
Background		
Platform controls		

Reflect & Write

What one technical or delivery change will make your next virtual presentation stronger?

12 AI Lab: Rehearsal Coach

Step	Action
1. Record	Deliver or transcribe 60-90 seconds without confidential details.
2. Request	Ask for scores on clarity, structure, audience focus, concision, and tone.
3. Improve	Check the evidence and revise only the weakest high-impact passage.
4. Compare	Deliver again and add human feedback on pace, posture, eye contact, and presence.

Ready-to-Use Prompt

Act as a presentation rehearsal coach. Review this 60-90 second transcript for [client/audience]. Score each area from 1-5: clarity, structure, audience focus, concision, and confidence/tone. Cite one specific example for each score. Suggest the three highest-impact improvements, then rewrite only the weakest passage in a natural voice. Do not add facts. Transcript: [paste transcript].

Feedback Rubric

Clarity	Structure	Audience Focus	Concision	Tone
/ 5	/ 5	/ 5	/ 5	/ 5

Weakest passage	
Evidence behind the feedback	
My revised passage	
Human feedback on presence	

Reflect & Write

Which feedback did you accept, reject, or rewrite - and why?

13 Handle Difficult Moments Professionally



Situation	Useful Response Pattern	My Words
I do not know the answer.	Acknowledge the question, state what you know, and commit to a realistic follow-up.	
I forget what comes next.	Pause, return to the main message or agenda, and use your structure to restart.	
A client notices a mistake.	Acknowledge it calmly, correct it if possible, and clarify the accurate information.	

Do not rush to protect your image.

Calm ownership, an accurate correction, and a clear next step usually protect credibility better than defensiveness.

My Recovery Plan

My most difficult situation	
What I tend to do under pressure	
Pause sentence I can use	
Accurate next step I can offer	
Support material I should prepare	

Reflect & Write

How can you stay honest and useful when you do not have an immediate answer?

14 Final Practice and Personal Commitment



In two minutes, present a technical idea or solution to a client using your opening, three-point body, and closing action.

Criterion	1	2	3	4	5	Evidence / Feedback
Audience focus						
Clear structure						
Concise message						
Visual support						
Voice + presence						
Professional Q&A						

My Presentation Commitment

Strongest presentation skill	
Priority improvement	
Practice action within 48 hours	
Evidence I will produce	
Person who can give feedback	
Review date	

Final Commitment

Complete this sentence: In my next presentation, I will...
